

MICHAEL GALBRAITH PURVIS

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Technical Leadership — Project & Product Management · 20 years shipping products · Pursuing PMP certification

SUMMARY

Engineering leader with 20 years in new-product development, moving deliberately from hands-on engineering into project and product leadership. Led cross-functional delivery across three vehicle programs at an EV manufacturer; managed a 5-engineer R&D team and third-party development studios in regulated casino gaming; served as Project Manager, Development Lead, and Site Manager on a federal simulation contract; founded and ran a consultancy owning scope, schedule, phased delivery plans, and client outcomes end to end. Deep, current fluency in generative-AI tooling and AI-assisted workflows. A career spent building demanding real-time software — now focused on leading the teams and programs that deliver products.

LEADERSHIP & PROGRAM HIGHLIGHTS

- Led a 3-engineer HMI team through concurrent delivery on three vehicle programs at Canoo — architecture ownership, schedule and scope alignment with vehicle-program milestones, hiring panels, mentoring, and engineering standards.
- Managed and trained third-party development studios at Konami, driving their delivery onto Konami platforms and processes — vendor oversight from onboarding through on-platform release in a regulated industry.
- Served as Project Manager, Development Lead, and Site Manager (Chickasaw Nation Industries) on a federal military-simulation contract; recruited and hired the engineering and art team.
- Directed planning, tasking, time budgeting, interviewing, and mentoring for a 5-engineer Games R&D team at Konami.
- As founder of Context Arcana, scoped and shipped a multi-workstream product platform (rendering engine, data pipeline, cloud services, mobile app, admin tooling) using phased executable specifications, review gates, acceptance criteria, and documented decision records — an AI-accelerated delivery practice built end to end.
- Drove process improvement throughout: a Python documentation-automation tool that cut a 6-month deliverable to 2 months; team standards and internal demo cadences; performance budgets that took embedded UI from 8 to 60+ fps.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder & Principal — Context Arcana LLC, Fort Collins, CO May 2026 – present

- Run client engagements end to end: discovery, requirements refinement with non-technical stakeholders, phased implementation plans, delivery, and support — owning scope, schedule, and outcomes.
- Planned and delivered an online art-registration and delivery platform across five coordinated workstreams (computer-vision pipeline, WebGL rendering, cloud/database services, mobile app, admin console), managed through written phase specifications with explicit acceptance criteria and stakeholder review gates.
- Built an AI-native delivery practice: generative-AI-assisted development, automated content pipelines, and a Stripe-integrated automated storefront (Agentic Tarot) operating with minimal human intervention.

Staff Real-Time Software Engineer — Prodigy Labs (pre-seed) Oct 2025 – Jun 2026

- Built the real-time MetaHuman layer of an AI-mentor platform, integrating Unreal Engine Pixel Streaming with a cloud agentic-LLM backend.

Director of Engineering — Grimigeon Games (pre-seed) Jun 2025 – Apr 2026

- Founding leadership: set technical pillars and direction for a UE5 studio; ran engineering hiring.

Senior Software Engineer (Contract) — Mercor Intelligence Jan 2025 – Aug 2025

- Authored prompts, evaluations, and test harnesses used to train advanced AI models on complex software-engineering tasks — annotation and grading of model output as part of a large engineering team; built AI developer-productivity tooling.

Lead HMI Software Engineer — Canoo Nov 2021 – Jan 2025

- Led the UI/HMI team delivering the main touchscreen and dash-display products across three vehicle programs; the coordination point between design, engineering, and vehicle-program schedules.
- Owned architecture decisions (C++, Qt/QML, Unreal Engine) and drove performance from 8 to 60+ fps on NXP i.MX8 automotive hardware; ran hiring, interview panels, mentoring, internal demos, and team standards.

Senior Systems Engineer — Heart Machine Apr 2021 – Nov 2021

- Shipped Solar Ash (PS4/PS5/PC, Dec 2021) — UI and systems engineering.

Software Engineer IV → Team Lead — Konami Gaming, Inc. Jun 2019 – Apr 2021

- Led a 5-engineer R&D team: planning, tasking, time budgeting, interviewing, mentoring — in a compliance-driven gaming environment.
- Managed and trained third-party studios on Konami development processes and hardware, driving their on-platform delivery.

Senior Game Programmer / Team Lead — United Power Aug 2018 – Jun 2019

- Team lead on a web-based MMO (JavaScript, Vue, GraphQL, WebGL).

Software Engineer III — Konami Gaming, Inc. Feb 2017 – Aug 2018

- C++ development for slot titles; evaluated and prototyped Unreal Engine 4 for a next-generation product platform.

Earlier roles — Alatec / TecMasters / Midnight Studios / Janus Research / Chickasaw Nation Industries / Lifetouch 2006 – 2017

- Principal Software Engineer (Janus): led the FBI Crime Scene Training Game; built a Python documentation-automation tool cutting a 6-month effort to 2 months.
- Senior Software Engineer / Project Lead (Chickasaw Nation Industries): designed an intelligent-agent military simulation; Project Manager, Development Lead, and Site Manager in year two; program planning in MS Project; recruited and hired engineers and artists.
- Software Engineer III (Midnight Studios): shipped 4-player splitscreen GUI features for Borderlands 2 / The Pre-Sequel; designed and led a small UE4 title. Additional simulation and workplace-automation development in C++, C#, .NET, and SQL.

SKILLS

Program & delivery: project planning, schedules & milestones, JIRA and Agile delivery (Scrum, Kanban) used across nearly every role, MS Project (Chickasaw Nation Industries), tasking and time budgeting, phased specifications with acceptance criteria, review gates, documentation control, risk surfacing and escalation, process improvement

Leadership: cross-functional team leadership, hiring and interview panels, mentoring, third-party/vendor management, stakeholder communication and demos, requirements refinement with users

Automation & AI: generative-AI-assisted development and delivery, agentic workflow design, LLM tooling, automation pipelines, computer vision (OpenCV)

Technical foundation: 20 years across C++, C#/.NET, Python, JavaScript/TypeScript, SQL; embedded/automotive, console, web, cloud, and mobile product development

EDUCATION, CERTIFICATIONS & SERVICE

B.S., Visual & Game Programming — The Art Institute of California, San Francisco · 2008 | A.S., Electronics Technology — Heald Institute of Technology · 1996
Pursuing PMP certification · Claude 101 (Anthropic, 2026) · Applied Agentic AI for SWEs — AI agents, RAG, vector databases, MCP, AI deployment (Interview Kickstart, 2025) · Fundamentals of Computer Vision & Image Processing in Python (OpenCV University, 2025) · AI Art Generation (OpenCV University, 2024) · Game Design (ELVTR) · Pixar RenderMan Certificate
U.S. Army — Specialist (E-4), M1A1 Armor Crewmember, 1990–1993 · Operations Desert Shield/Desert Storm · Honorable Discharge